CT70A3100 Service Design

Individual Report 1

Reflection on design and service design thinking: Value is co-created, from library e-books to SaaS support

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AI Clarification

ChatGPT was used to help structure the report and edit the language of a first draft. Grammar check was also used.

Aspects of design and service design thinking

Value co-creation. From lecture 2, it can be stated that services have been always existed; however, their channels keep on changing. A service becomes digital when its value chain is digital, for instance, people started using Spotify more instead of purchasing a CD. Cloud computing made Software as a Service (SaaS) possible. The supplier can only propose value, and the value is created when the customer uses the service (Lusch & Vargo, 2006).

Digital services. Lecture 3 showed that services have always existed, but the channels change over time. A service becomes digital when its value chain is digital, for instance, people started using music streaming services like Spotify, Apple Music more instead of buying a physical CD. Productized services are standard services sold like products. They scale easily, but they lose some personal interaction (Wolff & Hasan, 2026).

Videos. Service design considers the services through the viewpoint of the users according to Birgit Mager (n.d.). According to the video made by Fjord (n.d.), service design involves research and prototyping for improving customer experience. The two videos correspond to my findings during Primo Safari where small things become visible when using the service as the user.

Insights from tutorial exercises

GoMore (Tutorial 2). The booking process within the app was fairly straightforward, although my experience was inconsistent between cars and even owners. GoMore can only offer value creation; the car owners participate in it as well. During the group discussion, it became evident that the same service is perceived quite differently by different people. It taught me that value is subjective. (Lusch & Vargo, 2006).

LUT Primo (Tutorial 3). In our Service Safari (Stickdorn et al., 2011), we obtained an e-book through LUT Primo. Relationship value was high since we had LUT login, which automatically provided us access. Matching value was also high since we were able to locate the book easily. However, service value was relatively low since the hyperlink to open the e-book was just black-colored text that we could not notice at once. (Geiger et al., 2020).

Actor map (Tutorial 4). There were also lots of hidden actors when mapping Primo; such as the library, the university, the publishers, EU law, and the internet providers. Primo is a SaaS product provided by Ex Libris. Even a single process like lending an e-book relies on an entire service ecosystem. (Vink et al., 2020).

100 lines (Tutorials 5). Getting stuck in the 100 lines assignment was an experience that taught me about how constraints form thoughts. (Brown, 2008).

Connections to your own practice/experience

I have worked with SaaS products for several years: at GoTo as a Technical Account Manager for Miradore's mobile device management (MDM) and at Auga Technologies (QMob, Vevox). The lectures gave me words for things I see every day.

- As a Technical Account Manager at GoTo, I work closely in the relationship and matching layers. Customers already have the product and it is my responsibility to analyze and understand their needs, match them with the right features and people, and maintain relationship and strengthen them over time. Geiger et al. (2020) explains that the value of relationships is cumulative and I agree with this notion. One bad case of support may ruin the trust between customers and years of positive communication.

- ITIL 4 says the same thing. I studied ITIL 4 for my certification and my bachelor's thesis on critical incident management. ITIL 4 also says that value is co-created by the provider and the consumer (AXELOS, 2019). But ITIL starts from the organisation and its processes, while service design starts from the customer's experience. Combining both could be powerful.

- Productized support. Lecture 3 warned that productized services lose personal interaction. (Wolff & Hasan, 2026) I see this in support: standard ticket flows and chatbots scale well, but customers with complex problems often want to talk to a person. For instance, at my current workplace, where I handle customers' technical queries, the customer tends to try the chatbot or help articles first. When the problem is complex, they ask to talk to a person, and a short call often solves many ticket messages could not.

Conclusion with key takeaways and future reflection questions

Key takeaways:

1. Value is not delivered by the provider. It is co-created with the customer and decided by the customer.

2. The relationship, matching and service layers are a useful way to find where a service works and where it fails, as in our Primo safari.

3. Even a simple digital service depends on a whole ecosystem of actors that no one fully controls.

4. My daily work with SaaS customers is service design in practice, even if we do not call it that.

Questions I want to explore further:

• How can service design and ITIL 4 be combined, so IT processes are designed from the customer journey?

• When support becomes more productized and AI chatbots take over, how do we keep the relationship layer strong?

The last question matters to me because it connects to my daily work and to a possible topic for my master's thesis.

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